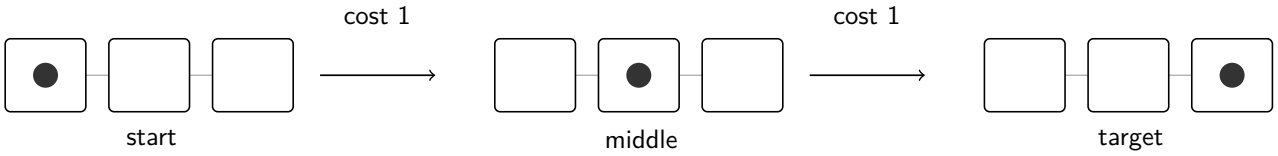
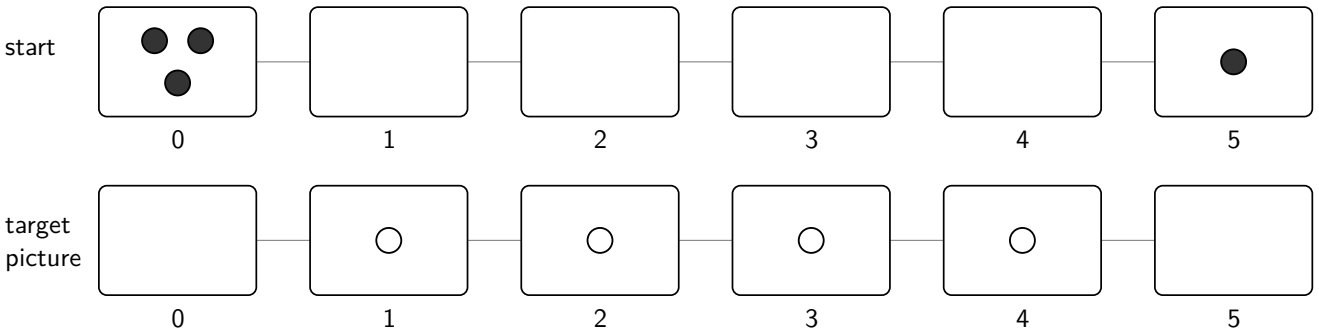
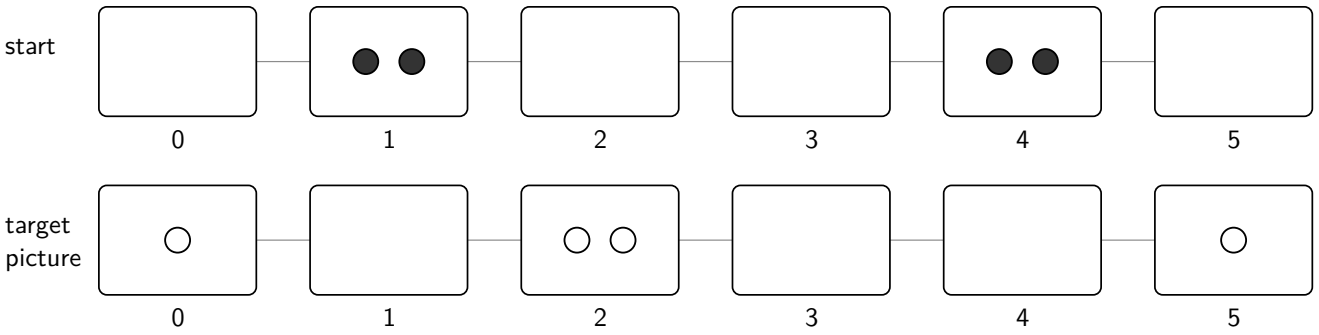
Move one counter at a time to a neighboring bin. Each crossing costs 1. Bins hold any number of counters, and counters may pass through occupied bins. Any counter may fill any target place. Only start counters move; the target picture stays fixed. Keep one record of your moves at a time so you can count the work afterward.

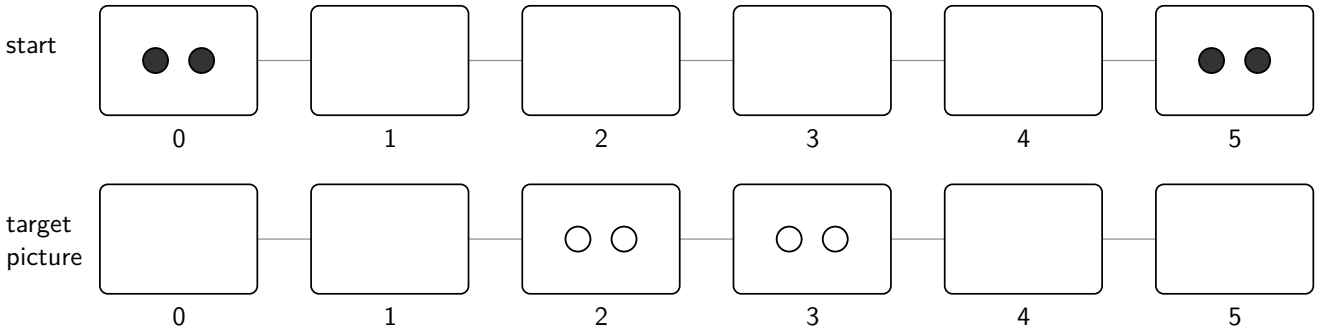


Problem 1: Make each start match its target using the least work you can. Find two best move records for each pair. Changing the order of moves counts as different.

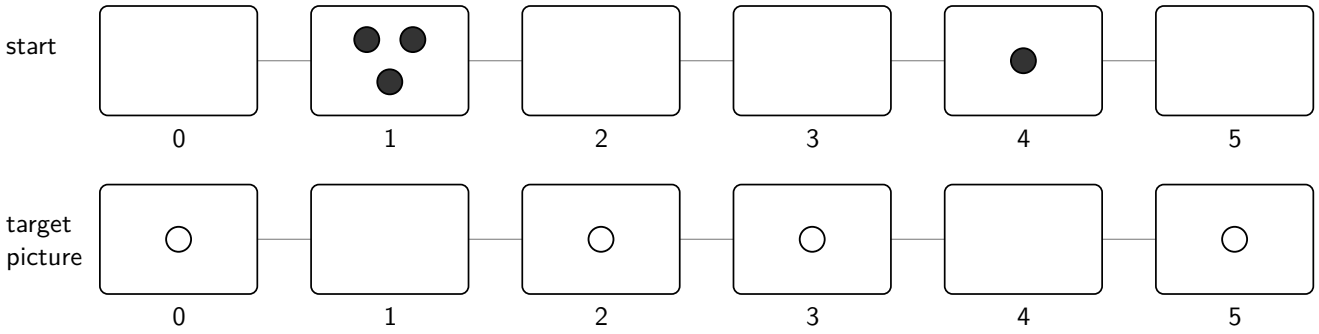




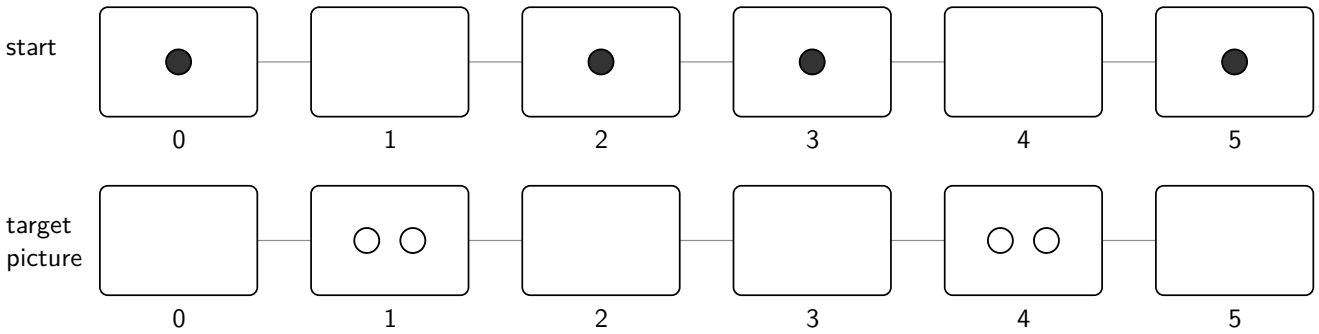
Problem 2: Find the least work for each pair. Explain why no plan can use less.



work: _____



work: _____



work: _____

Problem 3: A delivery takes one counter that has not yet been delivered all the way to one target place that has not yet been filled. Once delivered, that counter stays there. A rule says to make the shortest remaining delivery each time. Test this rule on both pairs. Does it always give the least work? Can tied choices change the result?

